Threat Vs Vulnerability

Term	Definition	Simple Analogy
Threat	Anything — person, event, or condition — that has the potential to cause harm by exploiting a weakness in a system.	It's the danger — the thing that could happen to cause damage.
Vulnerability	A weakness or flaw in a system that can be exploited by a threat to cause harm.	It's the weak spot that makes an attack possible.





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Threat Vs Vulnerability

No	Scenario	Category	Reasoning
1	An employee receives an email from “HR Department” asking to verify their login details via a link.	**Threat**	Phishing — an external malicious attempt to trick a user into revealing credentials.
2	A company server is running Windows Server 2012, which no longer receives security updates.	**Vulnerability**	Outdated/unpatched software — exploitable weakness due to lack of updates.
3	A developer accidentally uploads API keys to a public GitHub repository.	**Vulnerability**	Sensitive information exposure due to misconfiguration or human error.
4	A hacker uses a botnet to flood a website with traffic until it becomes unavailable.	**Threat**	DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service) — an active external attack.
5	The firewall in a branch office is misconfigured to allow all inbound traffic.	**Vulnerability**	Weak configuration that could be exploited.
6	An insider copies confidential customer data onto a personal USB drive.	**Threat**	Insider threat — intentional malicious activity by an authorized person.
7	The organization’s password policy allows users to set “12345” as their password.	**Vulnerability**	Weak access control due to poor policy enforcement.
8	Cybercriminals send ransomware through email attachments to multiple employees.	**Threat**	Ransomware — a direct cyberattack designed to harm and demand payment.
9	A company website doesn’t validate user input in its contact form, allowing malicious SQL commands.	**Vulnerability**	SQL Injection risk — a coding flaw in input validation.
10	Attackers use fake job advertisements on social media to trick users into sharing personal data.	**Threat**	Social engineering — psychological manipulation used to gain sensitive information.